

Plagiarism & Self-Plagiarism

Plagiarism : ApJ

- In the publication agreement authors warrant that their **work is original and has not been published elsewhere**. All parties are also expected to conform to common standards of professional respect and civility.
- **Plagiarism is the act of reproducing text or other materials from other papers without properly crediting the source.**
- Such material is regarded as being plagiarized regardless of **whether it is cited literally or has been modified or paraphrased**. Plagiarism represents a serious ethical breach, and may constitute legal breach of copyright if the reproduced material has been previously published.

Definition of Plagiarism includes ideas

Tod Lauer (NOIRLab):

Plagiarism is not the verbatim copying of text, even if it can show up that way. It is the unattributed theft of content or ideas from others. If I rip off your paper, I don't get a pass just because I can reword it a little.

- You can paraphrase (changing wording and syntax), but must still give credit
- See Roig 2015 for tips.

1) The work is yours

2) The work is new

ArXiv “text overlap”

<https://info.arxiv.org/help/overlap.html>

arXiv.org > astro-ph > arXiv:1704.02092

Search or Ask

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Astrophysics > High Energy Astrophysical Phenomena

Latest trends in the study of accretion and outflows around compact objects



(Submitted on 7 Apr 2017)

Study of astrophysics of black holes and neutron stars has taken a new turn in the present decade with the realization that sub-Keplerian flows and the associated centrifugal barrier near the horizon or the surface of a neutron star play a major role in deciding the nature of the emitted spectra and the formation of outflows from the accreting matter. This region may remain steady or oscillate depending on the accretion rate, specific angular momentum and specific energy of the flow. Intricacies of oscillation may depend on the degree of feedback the inflow receives from the outflow. This region may emit hard or soft X-rays depending on relative numbers of hot electrons and soft photons intercepted by this region. We discuss how these properties come about and how they explain the observational results of black hole candidates.

Comments: 13 pages 3 figures arXiv admin note: text overlap with [arXiv:astro-ph/0007259](https://arxiv.org/abs/1704.00072)

Subjects: **High Energy Astrophysical Phenomena (astro-ph.HE)**

ArXiv Text Overlap

- Submissions are sometimes marked with an "arXiv admin note" indicating text overlap with other arXiv articles. Determination of significant text overlaps is based on a statistical analysis of the existing arXiv corpus
- The indication of text overlap has been added to arXiv as a service for readers, who frequently find it useful to know when an article draws heavily from another or supersedes an earlier work. A text overlap note may therefore help identify related content.
- It can also be of assistance to authors who may not be aware that importing large sections of text either from their earlier articles or from articles by others is not common practice.
- Lastly, it may serve as a quality flag.

Example: Katherine Freese, Jan 2017

- This is serious. I've been accused of plagiarism in my latest paper on the physics arXiv, **and the issue was even brought up to the ethics division at the University of Michigan.**
- In fact, the problem is the other way around. My supposed plagiarism is actually based on plagiarism by Riotto of my earlier dark matter review in 2008.
- The entire Dark Matter section in his 2010 paper 1010.2642 consists entirely of words repeated verbatim from Freese <http://lanl.arxiv.org/abs/0812.4005> without attribution.
- I reuse my own text from one review to the next. I will now produce a version 2 of my recent paper 1701.01840 in which I **reference my own previous review**, the original source of the repeat paragraphs. I probably used the same text in an even earlier review article. All of these reviews are conference proceedings.
- I don't like to post this, **but I must protect my reputation.**

Riotto plagiarized not just Katherine ...

- Michael Brown: I've found a number of chunks of text that match up with other publications. For example, this block of text is by Linde and comes from Physical Cosmology (1991).
 - Joseph Conlon:
Curiouser and curiouser....section 2.3 of 1010.2642 is also plagiarised, lifted (unacknowledged), straight from Michael Turner's lectures, p353, of Quantitative Particle Physics: Cargese 1992
Section 8.3 is plagiarised from astro-ph/0305272 by Zaldarriaga
- Joseph Conlon you are on to something. I wonder if the entirety of 1010.2642 isn't plagiarized.

Initiation after CMB

Michael S. Turner
arXiv:astro-ph/9304012v1

1.2 Basics of the Big Bang Model

The standard cosmology is based upon the maximally spatially symmetric Robertson-Walker line element

$$ds^2 = dt^2 - R(t)^2 \left[\frac{dr^2}{1 - kr^2} + r^2(d\theta^2 + \sin^2\theta d\phi^2) \right]; \quad (2)$$

where $R(t)$ is the cosmic-scale factor, $R_{\text{curv}} \equiv R(t)|k|^{-1/2}$ is the curvature radius, and $k/|k| = -1, 0, 1$ is the curvature signature. All three models are without boundary: the positively curved model is finite and “curves” back on itself; the negatively curved and flat models are infinite in extent (though finite versions of both can be constructed by imposing a periodic structure: identifying all points in space with a fundamental cube). The Robertson-Walker metric embodies the observed isotropy and homogeneity of the Universe. It is interesting to note that this form of the line element was originally introduced for sake of mathematical simplicity; we now know that it is well justified at early times or today on large scales ($\gg 10$ Mpc), at least within our Hubble volume.

The coordinates, r , θ , and ϕ , are referred to as comoving coordinates: A particle at rest in these coordinates remains at rest, i.e., constant r , θ , and ϕ . A freely moving particle eventually comes to rest these coordinates, as its momentum is red shifted by the expansion, $p \propto R^{-1}$. Motion with respect to the comoving coordinates (or cosmic rest frame) is referred to as peculiar velocity; unless “supported” by the inhomogeneous distribution of matter peculiar velocities decay away as R^{-1} . Thus the measurement of peculiar velocities, which is not easy as it requires independent measures of both the distance and velocity of an object, can be used to probe the distribution of mass in the Universe.

Physical separations (i.e., measured by meter sticks) between freely moving particles scale as $R(t)$; or said another way the physical separation between two points is simply $R(t)$ times the coordinate separation. The momenta of freely propagating particles decrease, or “red shift,” as $R(t)^{-1}$, and thus the wavelength of a photon stretches as $R(t)$, which is the origin of the cosmological red shift. The red shift suffered by a photon emitted from a distant galaxy $1+z = R_0/R(t)$; that is, a galaxy whose light is red shifted by $1+z$, emitted that light when the Universe was a factor of $(1+z)^{-1}$ smaller. Thus, when the light from the most distant quasar yet seen ($z = 4.9$) was emitted the Universe was a factor of almost six smaller; when CBR photons last scattered the Universe was about 1100 times smaller.

Particle Cosmology

A. Riotto
arXiv:1010.2642v1

The standard cosmology is based upon the maximally spatially symmetric Friedmann-Robertson-Walker (FRW) line element

$$ds^2 = -dt^2 + a(t)^2 \left[\frac{dr^2}{1 - kr^2} + r^2(d\theta^2 + \sin^2\theta d\phi^2) \right]; \quad (1)$$

where $a(t)$ is the cosmic-scale factor, $R_{\text{curv}} \equiv a(t)|k|^{-1/2}$ is the curvature radius, and $k = -1, 0, 1$ is the curvature signature. All three models are without boundary: the positively curved model is finite and curves back on itself; the negatively curved and flat models are infinite in extent. The Robertson-Walker metric embodies the observed isotropy and homogeneity of the universe. It is interesting to note that this form of the line element was originally introduced for the sake of mathematical simplicity; we now know that it is well justified at early times or today on large scales ($\gg 10$ Mpc), at least within our visible patch.

The coordinates, r , θ , and ϕ , are referred to as *co-moving* coordinates: A particle at rest in these coordinates remains at rest, i.e., constant r , θ , and ϕ . A freely moving particle eventually comes to rest in these coordinates, as its momentum is redshifted by the expansion, $p \propto a^{-1}$. Motion with respect to the co-moving coordinates (or cosmic rest frame) is referred to as peculiar velocity; unless supported by the inhomogeneous distribution of matter, peculiar velocities decay away as a^{-1} . Thus the measurement of peculiar velocities, which is not easy as it requires independent measures of both the distance and velocity of an object, can be used to probe the distribution of mass in the universe.

Physical separations between freely moving particles scale as $a(t)$; or said another way the physical separation between two points is simply $a(t)$ times the coordinate separation. The momenta of freely propagating particles decrease, or redshift, as $a(t)^{-1}$, and thus the wavelength of a photon stretches as $a(t)$, which is the origin of the cosmological redshift. The redshift suffered by a photon emitted from a distant galaxy $1+z = a_0/a(t)$; that is, a galaxy whose light is redshifted by $1+z$, emitted that light when the universe was a factor of $(1+z)^{-1}$ smaller. When the light from the most distant quasar yet seen ($z = 4.9$) was emitted, the universe was a factor of almost six smaller; when CMB photons last scattered, the universe was about 1100 times smaller.

Particle cosmology

A. Riotto (CERN)

In these lectures the present status of the so-called standard cosmological model, based on the hot Big Bang theory and the inflationary paradigm is reviewed. Special emphasis is given to the origin of the cosmological perturbations we see today under the form of the cosmic microwave background anisotropies and the large scale structure and to the dark matter and dark energy puzzles.

Comments: 48 pages, Lectures given at the 5th CERN-Latin-American School of High-Energy Physics, Recinto Quirama, Colombia, 15 – 28 Mar 2009. References to Katherine Freese, E.W. Kolb, M. Turner, A. Linde and M. Zaldarriaga added and properly acknowledged with hopefully proper apologies. arXiv admin note: substantial text overlap with [arXiv:hep-ph/0210162](#); text overlap with [arXiv:astro-ph/0305272](#), [arXiv:0812.4005](#), [arXiv:astro-ph/9806122](#), [arXiv:hep-ph/9910311](#), [arXiv:astro-ph/0508279](#) by other authors; text overlap with [arXiv:astro-ph/0605575](#), [arXiv:hep-ph/0411301](#) by other authors without attribution

Subjects: **High Energy Physics – Phenomenology (hep-ph)**; Cosmology and Nongalactic Astrophysics (astro-ph.CO); General Relativity and Quantum Cosmology (gr-qc)

Cite as: [arXiv:1010.2642 \[hep-ph\]](#)
(or [arXiv:1010.2642v3 \[hep-ph\]](#) for this version)
<https://doi.org/10.48550/arXiv.1010.2642> 

Journal reference: CERN Yellow Report CERN-2010-001, pp. 315–362

8.4 Dark matter

Another topic we marginally touched in the lectures was dark matter, while we will not discuss the dark energy puzzle we did not have time to cover in detail. This section is taken verbatim from [Freese](#) [19].

Self-Plagiarism

Self-Plagiarism is defined as a type of plagiarism in which the writer republishes a work in its entirety or reuses portions of a previously written text while authoring a new work.

The American Psychological Association (2010) explains how plagiarism differs from self-plagiarism: “Whereas plagiarism refers to the practice of claiming credit for the words, ideas, and concepts of others, self-plagiarism refers to the practice of presenting one’s own previously published work as though it were new” (pg. 170).

As Roig (2006) suggests, self-plagiarism occurs “when authors reuse their own previously written work or data in a ‘new’ written product without letting the reader know that this material has appeared elsewhere”(pg. 16).

– Excerpts from the Ithenticate white paper

Self-plagiarism

Example 1: a student turns in a paper (or portion of one) they wrote for another class, and passing it off as original work both times.

Example 2: A conference proceeding is published in a copywritten compilation (e.g. Springer as publisher). A paper is later published in a journal (new copywrite) with the exact same text.

Self-Plagiarism - ApJ

- ApJ Plagiarism policy includes repeating text from previously published papers by the author or authors (i.e. "self-plagiarism").
- Authors who wish to quote directly from other published work must fully cite the original reference, and include any cited text in quotation marks.
- Figures may only be reproduced with permission and must be fully cited in the figure caption, following guidelines that are posted on the ApJ and AJ Web sites.

Self-Plagiarism & new policies

- Who is really benefitting from the new policy. Publishers? Scientists?
- Who suffers if authors reuse their own text?
- Can you even steal from yourself? Does self-plagiarism even exist?
- Examples where this happens in astronomy :
 - Introductions
 - Description of Observations/ Data Reduction
 - Proposals/Conference Proceedings

Expectations of Originality

Is it ok to self-plagiarize if it's just the introduction or methods?

Lucianne Walkowicz:

- In our field, it seems to me that many people have a general expectation that background material be "recycled", while the expectation of "new work" applies to analysis/results/discussion.

Why the ApJ self-plagiarism policy was enacted

From Ethan Vishniac (editor in chief of ApJ):

- Let me say that the ban on self-plagiarism (or if you like, copying your previous work without attribution) is not absolute, but is **meant to prevent repetition in the literature.**
- The ethical aspect comes from the point that the ban is meant to **prevent people from inflating their apparent productivity.**
- Although the detection program is entirely mechanized, whether or not a particular instance is egregious enough to require rewriting is at the discretion of the editor. The software is meant to point to possible problems not to pass judgment. Generally speaking, repeating yourself to any significant degree is a sign that you should be more terse.

Reasons for a self-plagiarism (or re-use) policy

Jason Wright:

- If the text is from a paper published by another publisher, then there are **copyright issues** (because the authors do not hold the copyright!) – the harmed party is the one who holds the copyright
- If there are **multiple authors to a paper**, then they are all equally "authors" of the words used. If you re-use text from one paper in another with a different author list, then it meets the technical definition of plagiarism. This is no big deal if you personally wrote every one of those words, but if the other authors helped with that text then you are reusing their work without attribution.
 - This applies to proposals **

Collaborators & re-use of text in proposals

John Gizis (U Delaware):

- Someone above said they'd never heard of a co-author complaining about re-used text [In the context of self-plagiarism].
- I certainly have heard people complaining that text, even figures, they (Dr. X) wrote for a joint proposal (i.e., by X & Y) ended up in other proposals or papers (by Y & Z).
- What should Dr. X. do ?

How to Avoid Self-Plagiarism

- Never start a paper with recycled text. Particularly the introduction.
- If you are repeating a methodology from a previous work, just tell the reader to look at that work (with minor details in this paper).
- Sometimes papers should be written as one complete work rather than broken into many smaller papers. If the introduction is totally the same, one may question why the paper merits being a “stand alone” publication.
 - Ithenticate White Paper